

position of the adapter card expansion slots, the number of slots, the relative size of the motherboard, and the orientation of the board in the chassis.

Baby AT (BAT)

The oldest of the mainstream motherboard form factors. The distinguishing features are its orientation in the chassis - the long axis goes from the back to the front of the chassis; the type of keyboard connector—typically referred to as a ‘large DIN’ connector; the presence of AT or PS/2 power supply connectors—a series of 12 ‘blades’ in one or two adjacent male connectors; and the implementation of the various I/O connectors—serial and parallel ports—via a bracket that goes into one of the adapter card slots at the rear of the chassis.

ATX

The most common of today’s mainstream motherboard form factors. The distinguishing features are its orientation in the chassis—the long axis goes from side-to-side at the rear of the chassis; the use of ‘integrated I/O connectors’—all the connectors are built into the motherboard and exit to the rear of the chassis through an ‘I/O shield’ where they are grouped together; and only an ATX power supply connector is provided.

MicroATX

A variation of the ATX form factor. It is much shorter in its long axis than ATX, and has fewer adapter card slots (three compared to ATX, which typically has seven).